



HELLO MATERIALS

Test data — layout review

■ MEDIA BUYING · CREATIVE TESTING

META TESTING SOP PROPOSAL

Four changes to how we judge, exit, recover and learn from creative tests
— each backed by our testing data.

PREPARED BY

MEDIA BUYING TEAM

DATE

SEPTEMBER 2026

FOR

MANAGEMENT REVIEW

FOUR CHANGES, ONE PROOF STRUCTURE

Each point runs Problem → Evidence → Root Cause → Solution → Expected Outcome.

POINT 01 FALSE KILLS AT THE FIRST GATE Judge at \$70 / \$100 on conversions, not soft metrics. OPEN →	POINT 02 VALIDATE THE EXIT GATE Is 10 results the signal that predicts scaling? OPEN →	POINT 03 THE ZOMBIE CAMPAIGN Recover creatives lost to testing side effects. OPEN →	POINT 04 JUDGE CONCEPTS, NOT CREATIVES Turn every test into production direction. OPEN →
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HOW WE TEST TODAY

Budget \$10/day per creative, cold audience	Checkpoint A \$70 Day 7	Checkpoint B \$100 Day 10	Exit gate 10 results → scaling: broad + CBO
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01

POINT ONE

FALSE KILLS AT THE FIRST GATE

Creatives are cut at \$70–\$100 on misleading soft metrics instead of real conversion performance.

04 We Kill Creatives That Were Never Fairly Tested

06 The Same \$70 Buys Very Different Evidence

08 Where the First-Gate Budget Actually Goes

10 Two-Stage First Gate: Signal Check at \$70, Hard Rule at \$100

12 First-Gate Decision Rules

05 Most Kills Happened Before a Buyer Saw the Ad

07 Cheap Geos Take the Budget and Inflate the Metrics We Judge

09 A Creative Can Fail at \$70 Without Meeting a Converting Audience

11 Walk a Creative Through the Gate

13 Fairer Tests, Earlier Kills, Less Waste



WE KILL CREATIVES THAT WERE NEVER FAIRLY TESTED

42.9%

false-kill rate — killed at the first gate, then converted when re-tested on Tier-1 geos

35 FIRST-GATE KILLS RE-TESTED ON TIER-1 GEOS

Converted on re-test · 15 No purchase · 20



→ Almost half of what we kill at \$70–\$100 can convert — we are throwing away working creatives.

MOST KILLS HAPPENED BEFORE A BUYER SAW THE AD

CREATIVE	SPEND AT KILL	LOW-CPM GEO SHARE	TIER-1 IMPRESSIONS	PURCHASES AT KILL	RE-TEST PURCHASES	RE-TEST CPA	VERDICT
C-104	\$100	71%	520	0	3	\$26.70	✗ FALSE KILL
C-109	\$70	66%	610	0	2	\$38.10	✗ FALSE KILL
C-113	\$100	38%	1,840	0	0	—	✓ CORRECT KILL
C-118	\$100	74%	470	0	4	\$21.40	✗ FALSE KILL
C-121	\$70	69%	590	0	0	—	✓ CORRECT KILL
C-126	\$100	29%	2,210	0	0	—	✓ CORRECT KILL
C-131	\$100	63%	700	0	2	\$33.90	✗ FALSE KILL
C-137	\$100	58%	880	0	1	\$52.00	✗ FALSE KILL

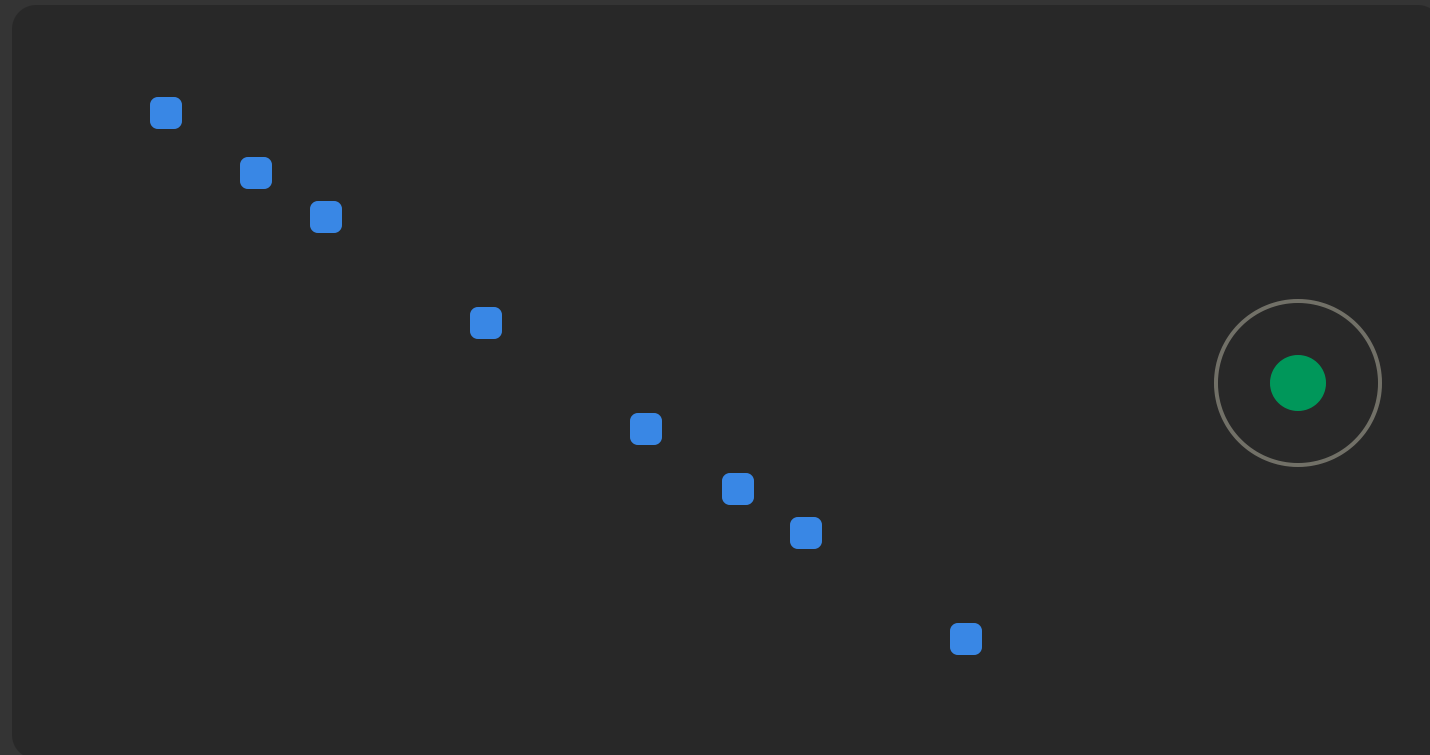
→ 6 of 8 had under 1,000 Tier-1 impressions when killed — and 5 of those 6 converted once they reached a real buyer.

THE SAME \$70 BUYS VERY DIFFERENT EVIDENCE

LOW-CPM DELIVERY · \$45 OF THE \$70

CHEAP IMPRESSIONS

12,900
impressions



↑ **SOFT METRICS LOOK STRONG**

✗ **0 PURCHASES**

TIER-1 DELIVERY · \$25 OF THE \$70

COSTLY IMPRESSIONS

410
impressions



↓ **TOO FEW TO JUDGE**

✓ **WHERE BUYERS ARE**

VS

→ One spend cap creates two unequal samples — soft metrics can't be read without knowing where Meta delivered the spend.

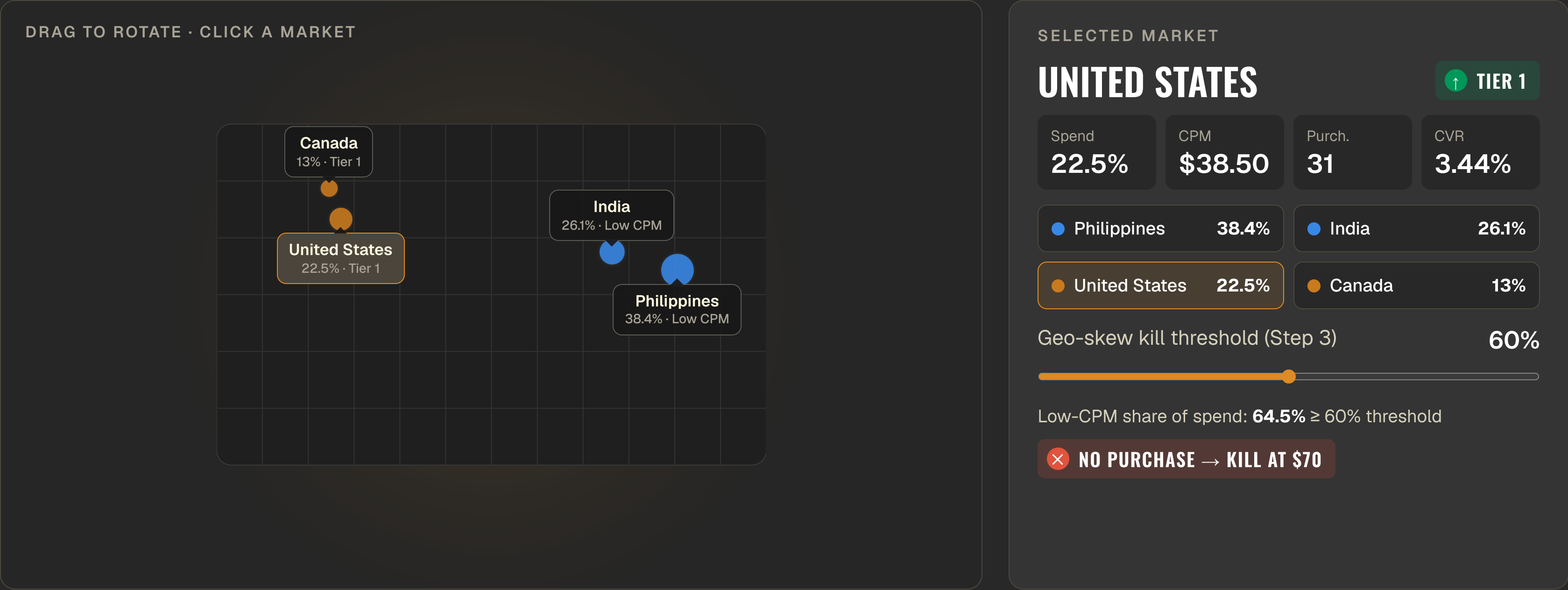
CHEAP GEOS TAKE THE BUDGET AND INFLATE THE METRICS WE JUDGE

COUNTRY	% SPEND	IMPR.	CPM	LPV	LPV RATE	ATC	PURCH.	CVR	TIER
Philippines	38.4%	1.10M	\$4.20	9,870	84.2%	42	0	0.00%	↓ LOW CPM
India	26.1%	1.12M	\$2.80	11,240	88.5%	31	0	0.00%	↓ LOW CPM
United States	22.5%	70.1K	\$38.50	900	42.1%	58	31	3.44%	↑ TIER 1
Canada	13.0%	50.0K	\$31.20	640	46.0%	29	18	2.81%	↑ TIER 1
Low-CPM total	64.5%	2.22M	\$3.51	21,110	86.5%	73	0	0.00%	
Tier-1 total	35.5%	120.1K	\$35.47	1,540	43.7%	87	49	3.18%	

First-gate spend across 120 creatives · \$12,000 · sorted by % of spend

→ Low-CPM countries took 64.5% of spend and 93% of landing-page views — and produced 0 of 49 purchases. The metrics we judge at \$70 are mostly cheap-geo noise.

WHERE THE FIRST-GATE BUDGET ACTUALLY GOES



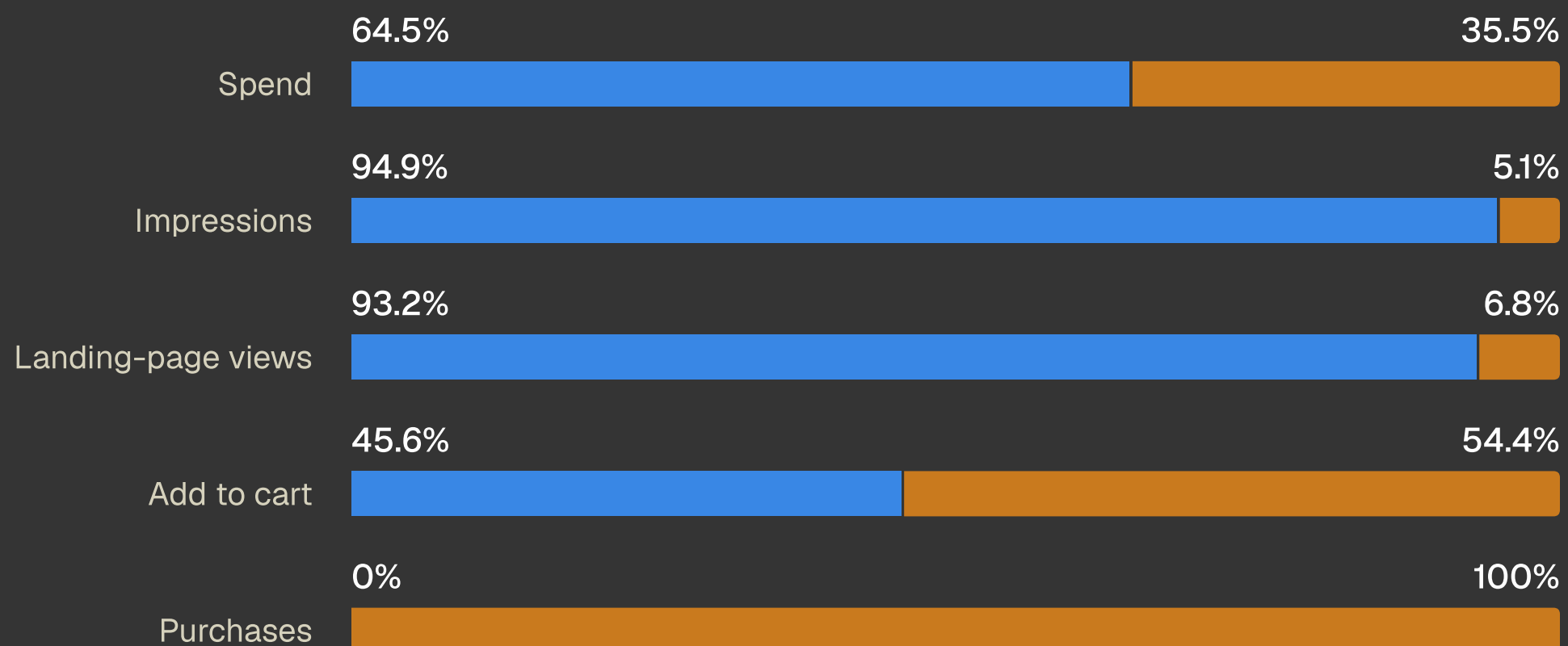
→ Tier-1 markets took 35.5% of spend yet produced every purchase. Fix the skew threshold once and Step 3 stops being a judgment call.

A CREATIVE CAN FAIL AT \$70 WITHOUT MEETING A CONVERTING AUDIENCE

SHARE OF EACH METRIC BY GEO TIER

Low-CPM geos

Tier-1 geos



A TYPICAL CREATIVE AT \$70

12,900

impressions in low-CPM geos

410

impressions in the USA — far below a fair sample

→ Cheap geos supply 95% of impressions but none of the purchases — so a strong creative can be judged on an audience that never buys.



TWO-STAGE FIRST GATE: SIGNAL CHECK AT \$70, HARD RULE AT \$100

CHECKPOINT A · DAY 7 · \$70 — SIGNAL CHECK



CHECKPOINT B · DAY 10 · \$100 Minimum 1 purchase by \$100 spend

✓ 1+ PURCHASE · PASS **× 0 PURCHASES · KILL**

→ At \$70 we only continue creatives that are genuinely under-delivered; at \$100, no purchase means kill — whatever the soft metrics say.

WALK A CREATIVE THROUGH THE GATE

PICK A SCENARIO AT \$70

Not enough impressions / LPV

Purchase achieved

Low-CPM geo skew · no purchase

Tier-1 · high CPM · strong metrics

Enough signal · weak metrics

DECISION

✕ **KILL AT \$70**

A1

ENOUGH IMPRESSIONS + LPV?

No → under-delivered · Yes → check purchase

YES

A2

PURCHASE ACHIEVED?

Yes → continue · No → check geo

NO

A3

WHERE DID THE SPEND GO?

Low-CPM → kill · Tier-1 → check secondary metrics

LOW-CPM

A4

SECONDARY METRICS STRONG?

Strong → continue · Weak → kill

—

B

\$100 HARD RULE

1+ purchase → pass · 0 purchases → kill

—

→ Every scenario resolves to one action — continue only when the creative converted or is genuinely under-delivered.

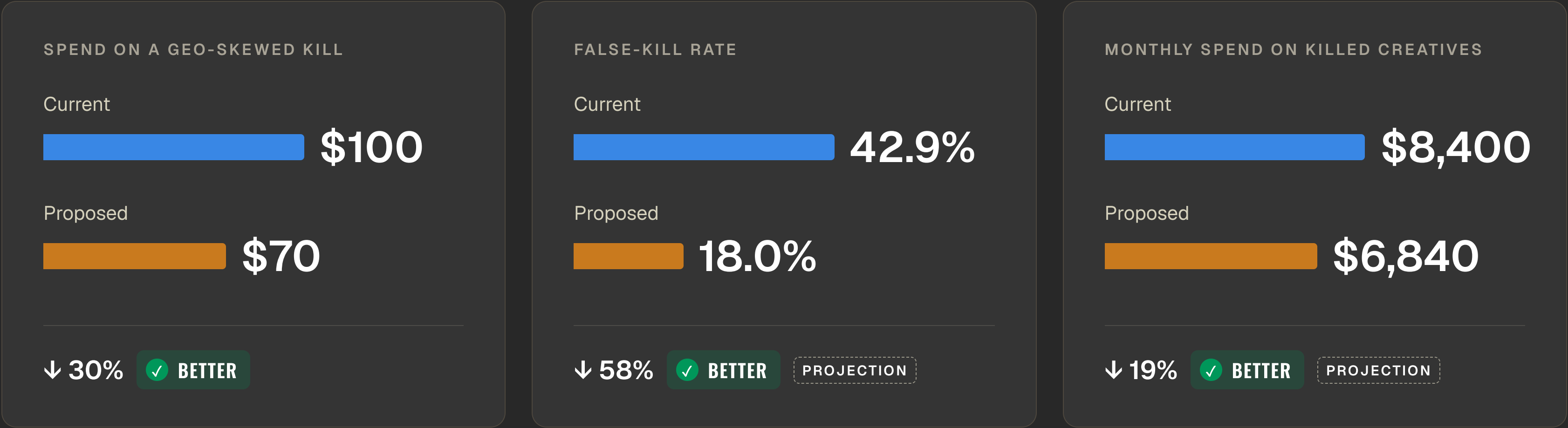


FIRST-GATE DECISION RULES

SPEND	CONDITION	DECISION
\$70	Not enough impressions / LP views	 CONTINUE
\$70	Purchase achieved	 CONTINUE
\$70	Tier-1 geo + high CPM + strong secondary metrics, no purchase	 CONTINUE
\$70	Spend skewed to low-CPM geos, no purchase	 KILL
\$70	Enough signal + weak secondary metrics + no purchase	 KILL
\$100	1+ purchase	 PASS
\$100	0 purchases	 KILL

FAIRER TESTS, EARLIER KILLS, LESS WASTE

Current process Proposed process PROPOSED = PROJECTION



→ Projected: geo-skewed creatives cut \$30 earlier, false kills more than halved, about \$1,560 a month back in the testing budget.

02

POINT TWO

THE EXIT GATE: DOES 10 RESULTS PREDICT QUALITY?

We move creatives to scaling after 10 results at \$10/day. We have never checked whether that count predicts success.

15 The 10-Result Gate Is Slow, Costly — and Unproven

17 Reaching 10 Results at \$10/Day Takes Two to Five Weeks

19 Scaling Campaigns Can Crowd Tests Out of the Auction

21 What 10 Results Does Get Right: A More Stable CPA

23 Exit on a Combined Signal: 75% Scaling Success vs 33% Today

25 Half the Spend to Exit, Twice the Survival

16 CPA at Exit Barely Predicts CPA After Scaling

18 \$10/Day Cold Tests Don't Match the Scaling Environment

20 ABO and CBO Can Hurt Each Other — or Help

22 How a Creative Reaches 10 Results Matters More Than the Count

24 New Exit Decision: Four Checks, Then Scale



THE 10-RESULT GATE IS SLOW, COSTLY — AND UNPROVEN

COST OF THE EXIT WINDOW

\$213

average spend between a creative's 1st and 10th result — about 21 days at \$10/day

AFTER IT EXITS

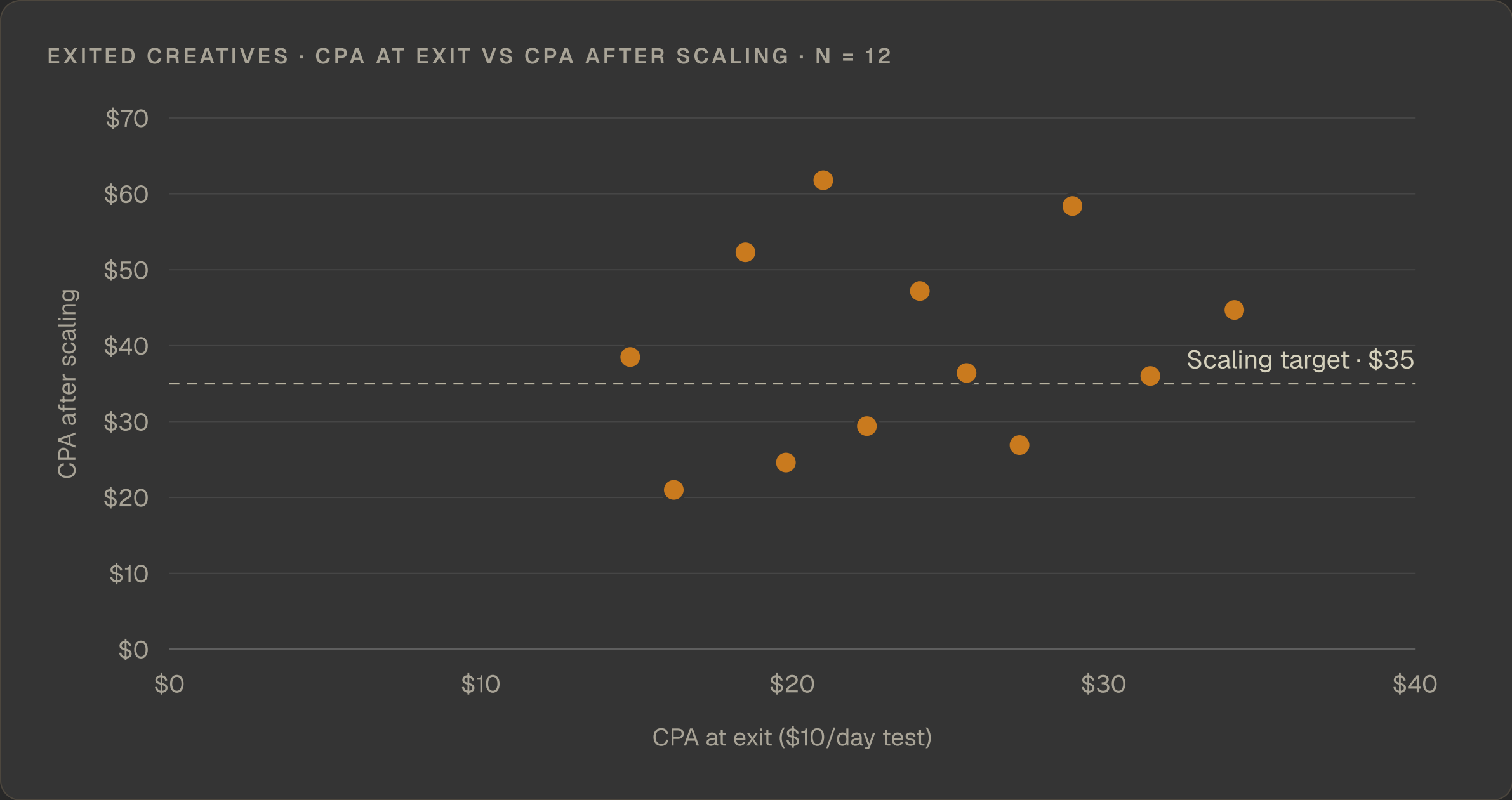
67%

of creatives that exited at 10 results failed in scaling within 7 days (8 of 12)

→ We spend three weeks qualifying each creative — and two in three still fail once they scale.



CPA AT EXIT BARELY PREDICTS CPA AFTER SCALING



CORRELATION

R² 0.04

Verdict: **weak**

4 of 12

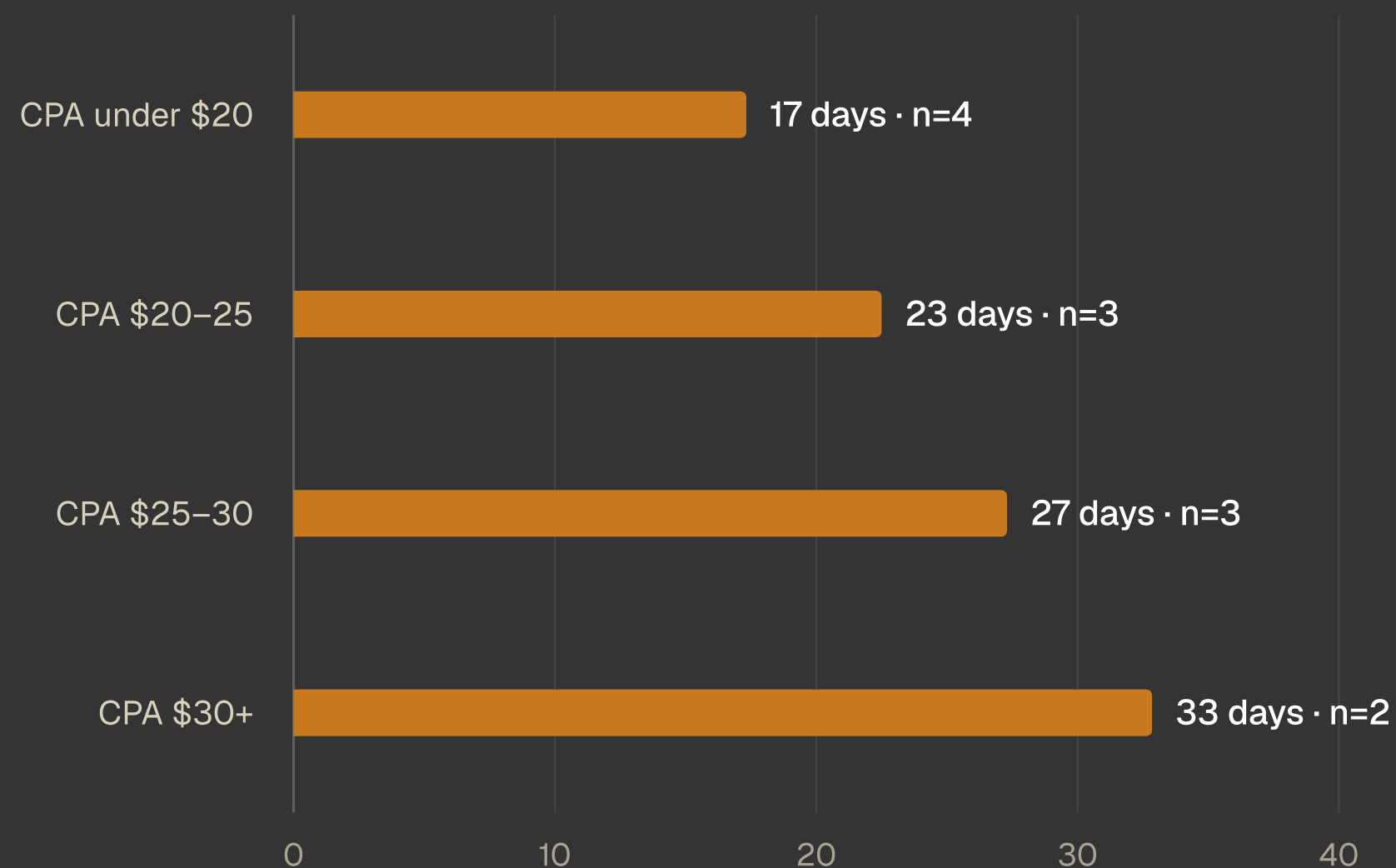
reached the scaling target (CPA ≤ \$35)

CLICK A POINT
to see one creative's exit vs scaled CPA.

→ R² = 0.04 — a weak relationship: CPA at exit explains about 4% of the variation in CPA after scaling.

REACHING 10 RESULTS AT \$10/DAY TAKES TWO TO FIVE WEEKS

DAYS FROM TEST START TO 10 RESULTS, BY CPA BAND



Fastest → slowest exit

15–34
days

Spent inside the window

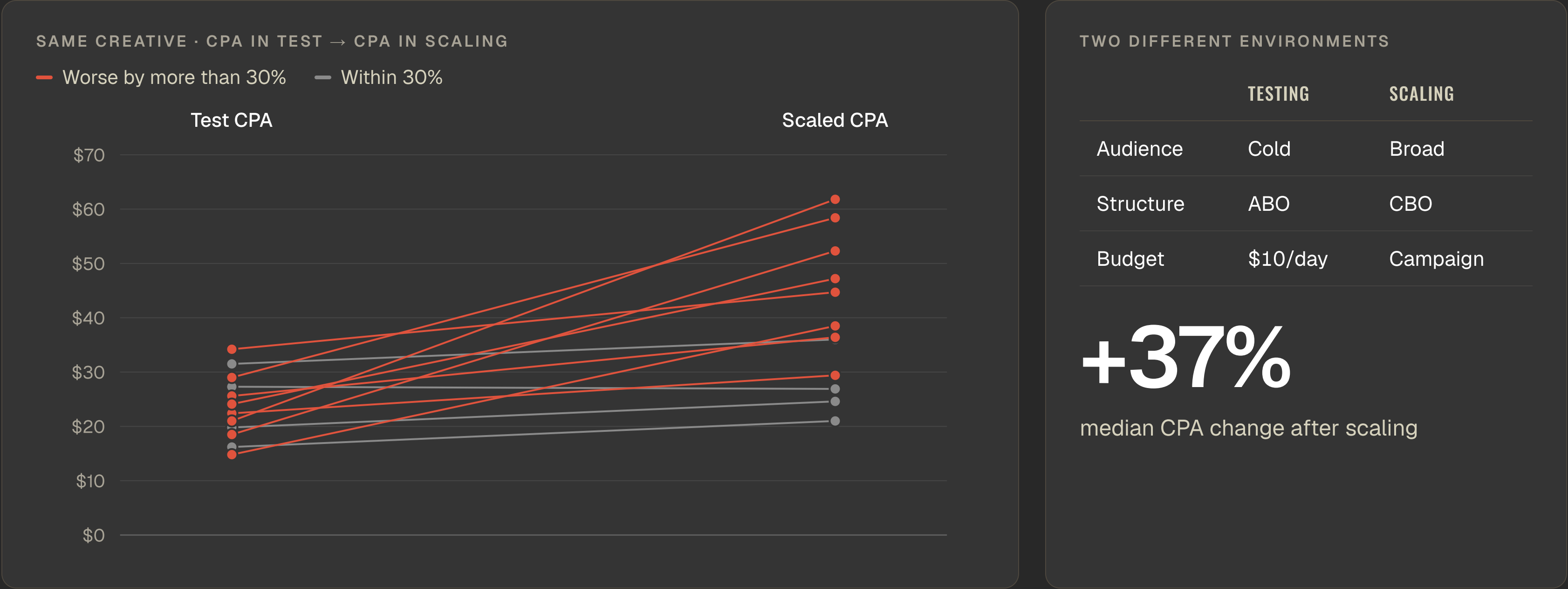
\$2,560

across 12 exited creatives

→ Every \$5 of CPA adds about 5 days before a creative can scale — a good creative waits weeks it doesn't need.

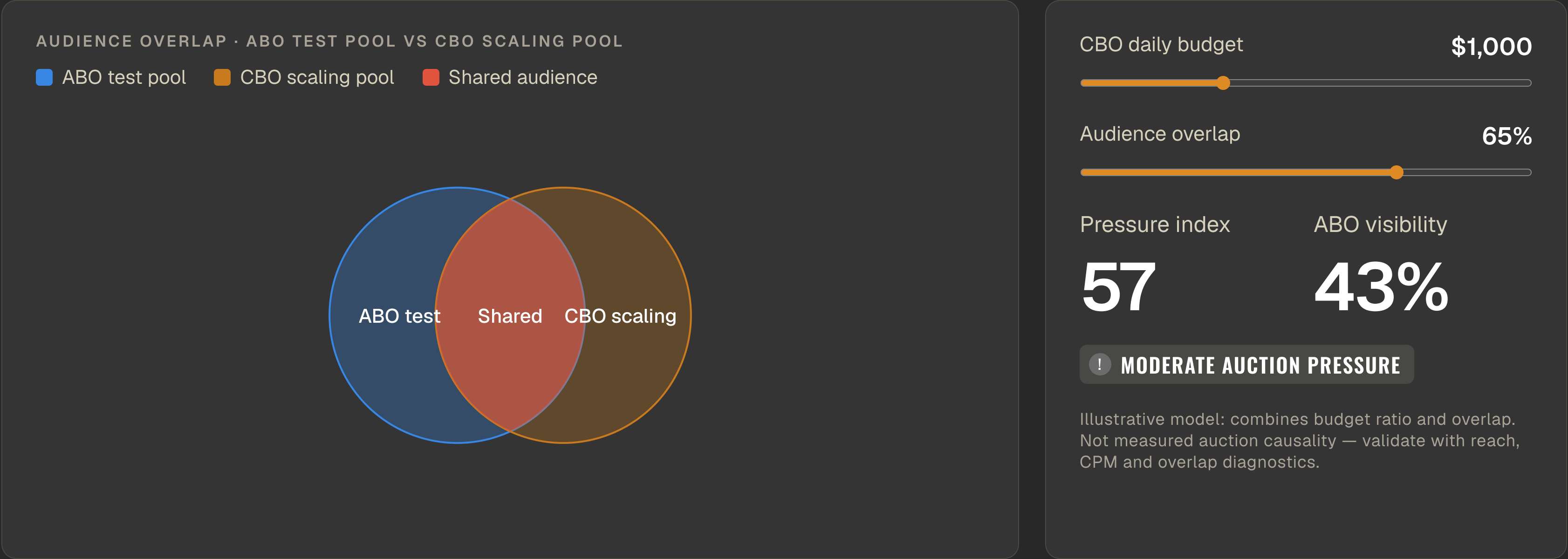


\$10/DAY COLD TESTS DON'T MATCH THE SCALING ENVIRONMENT



→ 8 of 12 creatives got more than 30% more expensive after moving from the cold \$10/day test to broad + CBO.

SCALING CAMPAIGNS CAN CROWD TESTS OUT OF THE AUCTION



→ When tests and scaling share an audience, the bigger budget wins the auction — tests under-deliver and get judged on thin data. Exclude scaling audiences from tests.

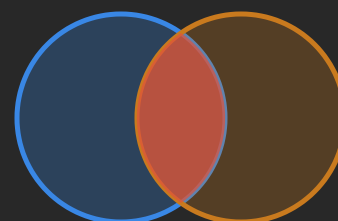
ABO AND CBO CAN HURT EACH OTHER — OR HELP

ABO TESTING SYSTEM

CONTROLLED CREATIVE TEST

Cold audience · one creative hypothesis per cell · **\$10/day** per creative

MEASUREMENT ROLE



SHARED ELIGIBLE USERS

Cold targeting and broad delivery can reach the same people

CBO SCALING SYSTEM

BROAD DELIVERY ENGINE

Broad audience · budget shifts to stronger opportunities · **campaign-level** budget

GROWTH ROLE

DAMAGE LOOP

Why the test becomes harder to trust

HELP LOOP

How both systems improve the next decision

DAMAGE: TESTING LOSES AN INDEPENDENT SAMPLE

Risk rises when the \$10 ABO test, other ABO creatives and the CBO reach the same people in the same period.

! MEASUREMENT RISK

1

ABO FRAGMENTS ITS OWN SIGNAL

Parallel \$10 creatives collect few events and split delivery across similar cold audiences.

2

CBO TAKES TEST OPPORTUNITIES

When both qualify for a person, Meta advances one ad set — the scaling campaign often wins.

3

THE NEXT CONVERSION GETS HARDER

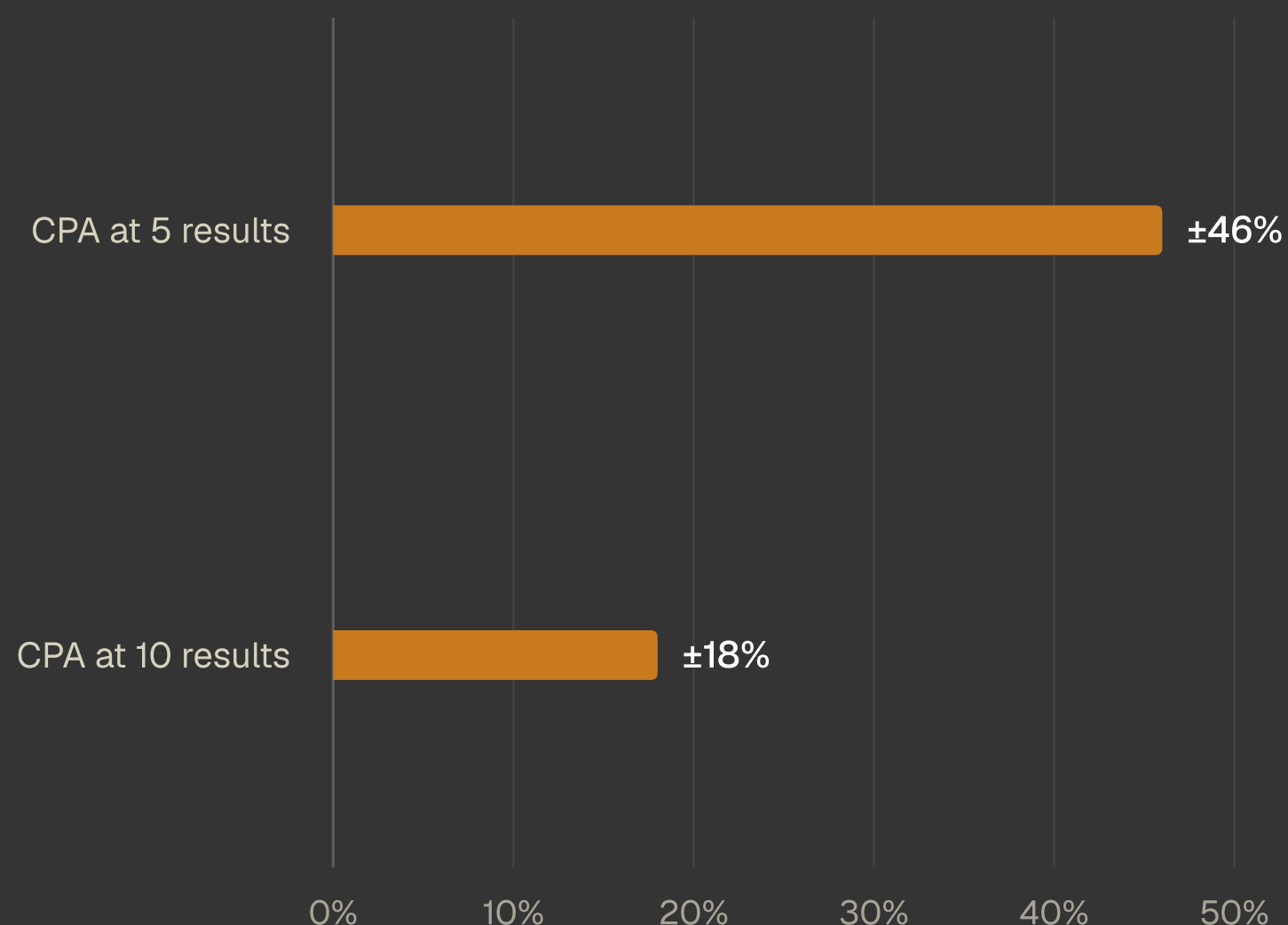
The test reaches high-intent people first; later impressions carry lower value and more repeats.

→ SOP rule: run ABO as a clean measurement cell, promote a winner into CBO once, pause duplicate delivery — then use scaling results and exclusions to shape the next test.



WHAT 10 RESULTS DOES GET RIGHT: A MORE STABLE CPA

AVERAGE DAY-TO-DAY CPA SWING



4 of 12

exited creatives scaled successfully

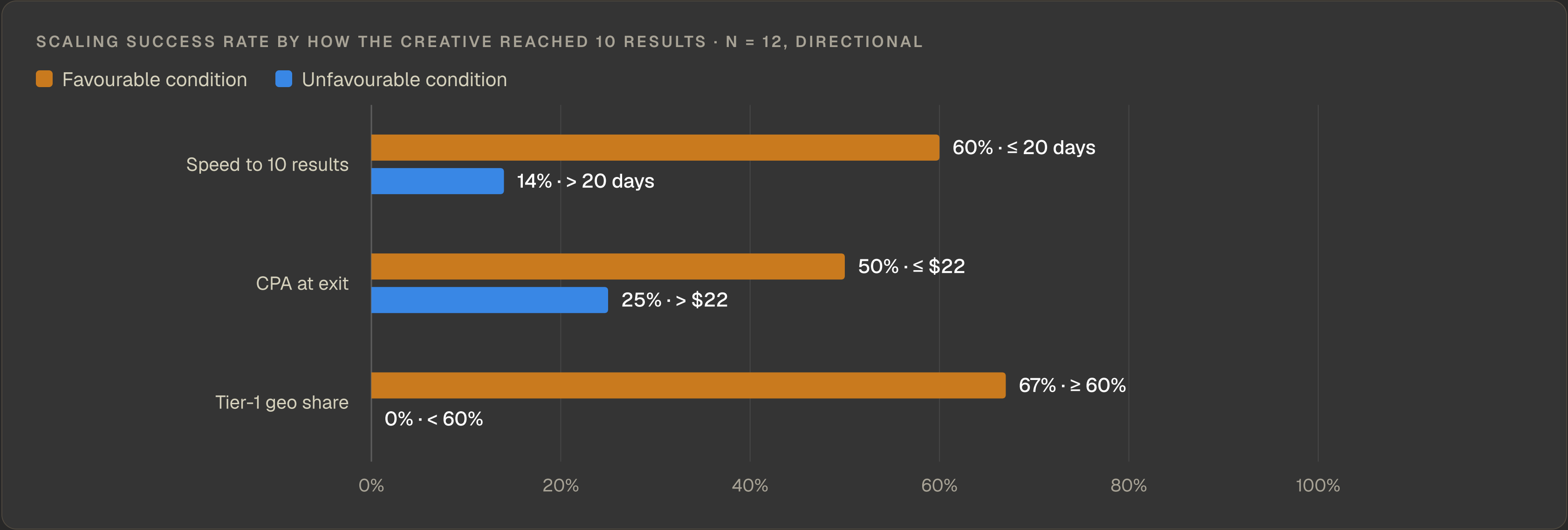
2.6 · 3.1

ROAS of the two top scalers — both exited at 10 results

→ The count buys reliability: CPA swings less at 10 results than at 5. The question is whether that is worth ~21 days.



HOW A CREATIVE REACHES 10 RESULTS MATTERS MORE THAN THE COUNT

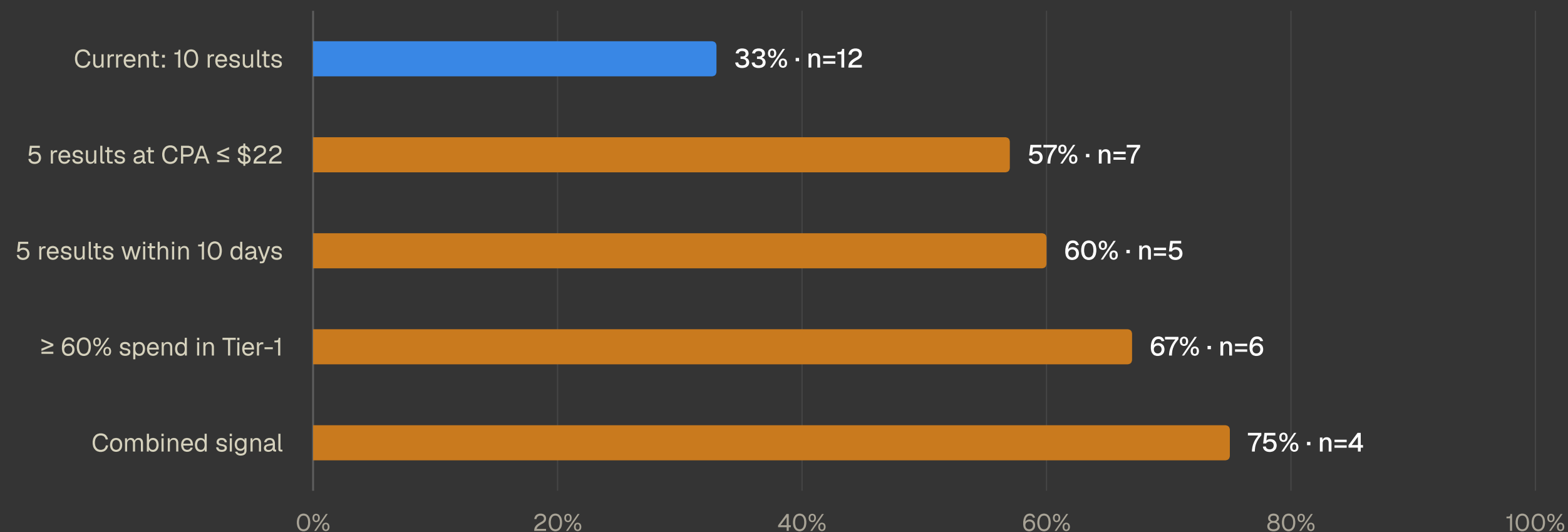


→ Fast, low-CPA, Tier-1 exits scaled far more often — two creatives with 10 results are not the same creative.

EXIT ON A COMBINED SIGNAL: 75% SCALING SUCCESS VS 33% TODAY

SHARE OF CREATIVES MEETING EACH CONDITION THAT SUCCEEDED IN SCALING · SOURCE: OUR DATA (TEST)

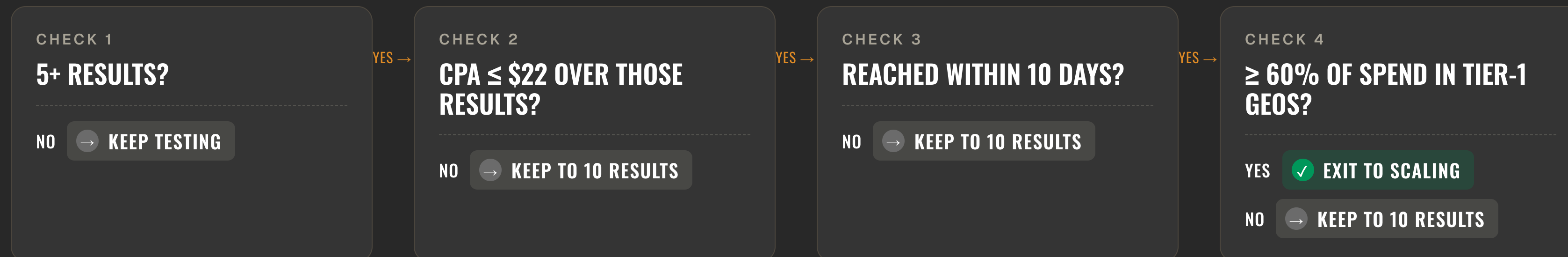
■ Current gate ■ Proposed signals



→ Not a guarantee — the highest success rate in our data. The combined signal rests on only 4 creatives, so we validate it before rollout.



NEW EXIT DECISION: FOUR CHECKS, THEN SCALE

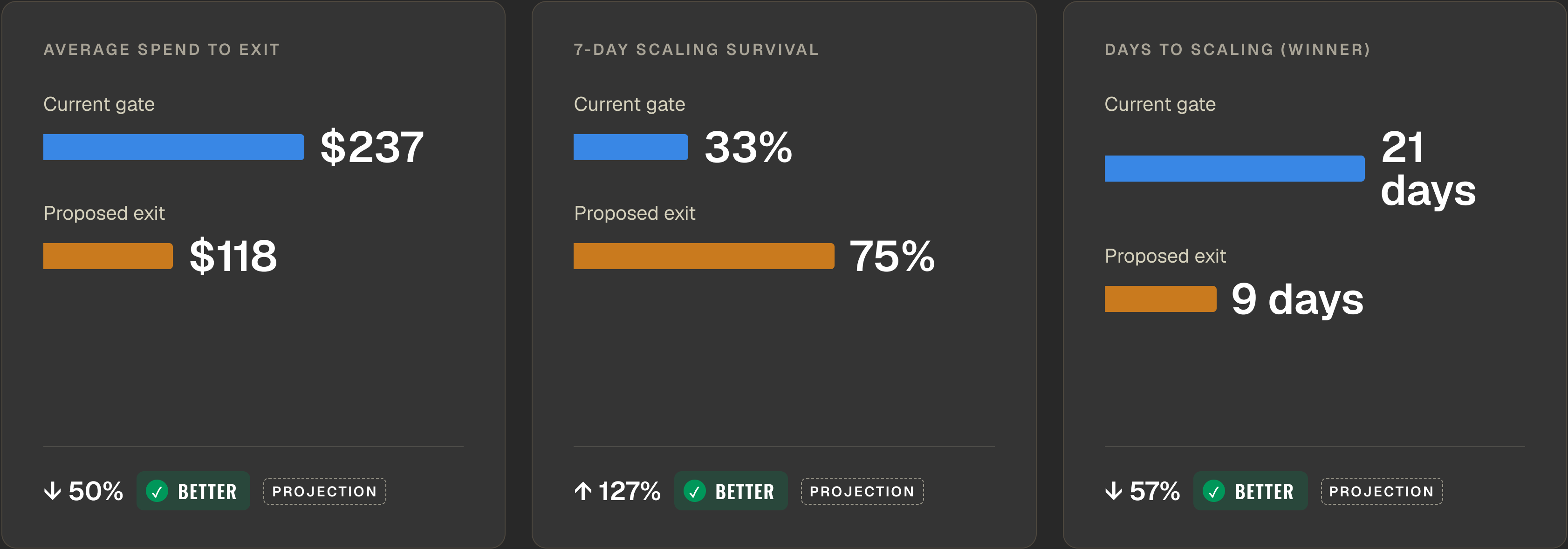


FALLBACK Creatives that miss any check keep the current rule: exit at 10 results.

→ Winners that prove themselves early exit early; everything else follows today's gate — nothing is lost by adding the fast lane.

HALF THE SPEND TO EXIT, TWICE THE SURVIVAL

■ Current gate ■ Proposed exit PROPOSED = PROJECTION



→ Projected: winners reach scaling in about 9 days instead of 21, on half the testing spend.

03

POINT THREE · IF POINT 2 IS NOT APPROVED

THE ZOMBIE CAMPAIGN

If we keep the current gate, here is how we stop losing the creatives it discards.

27 101 of Every 120 Tested Creatives Are Lost

29 The Cold Test Audience Runs Dry During the Stall

31 The Zombie Campaign Recovered 14 Creatives and \$14,250

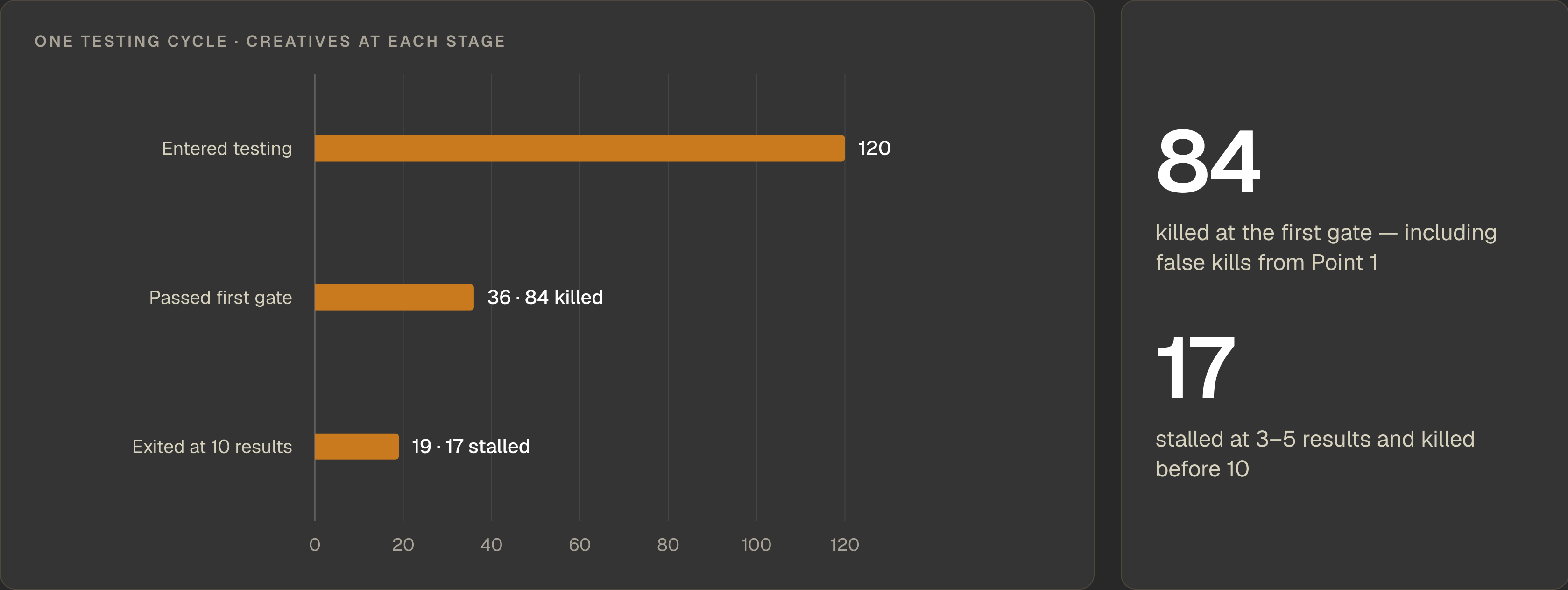
28 Stalls Eat Half the Profit Stalled Creatives Already Made

30 Route Lost Creatives Into the Zombie Campaign

32 Fewer Lost Creatives, Lower False-Kill Rate

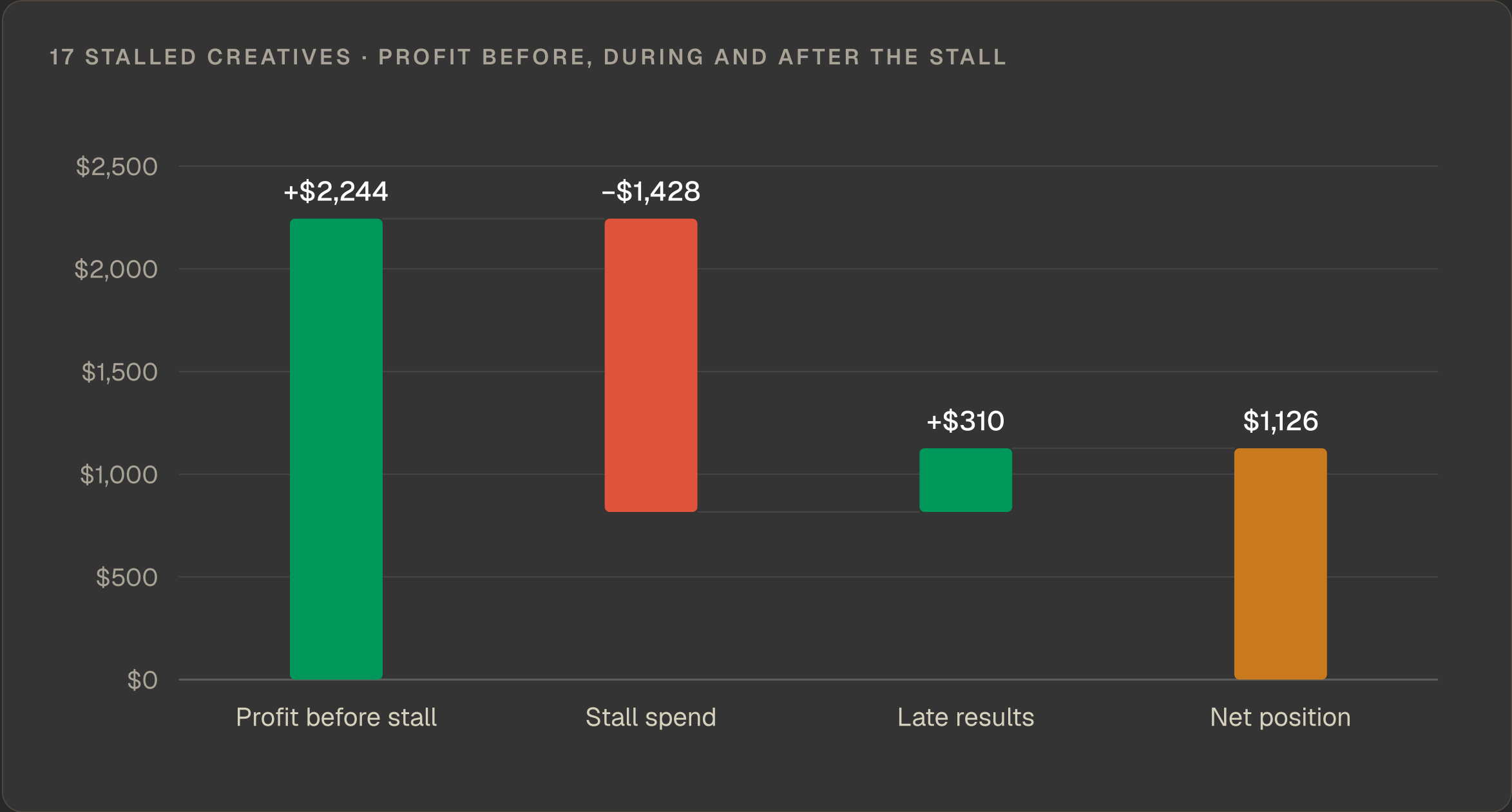


101 OF EVERY 120 TESTED CREATIVES ARE LOST



→ Both routes end the same way today: the creative is killed and the asset is gone.

STALLS EAT HALF THE PROFIT STALLED CREATIVES ALREADY MADE



8.4 days

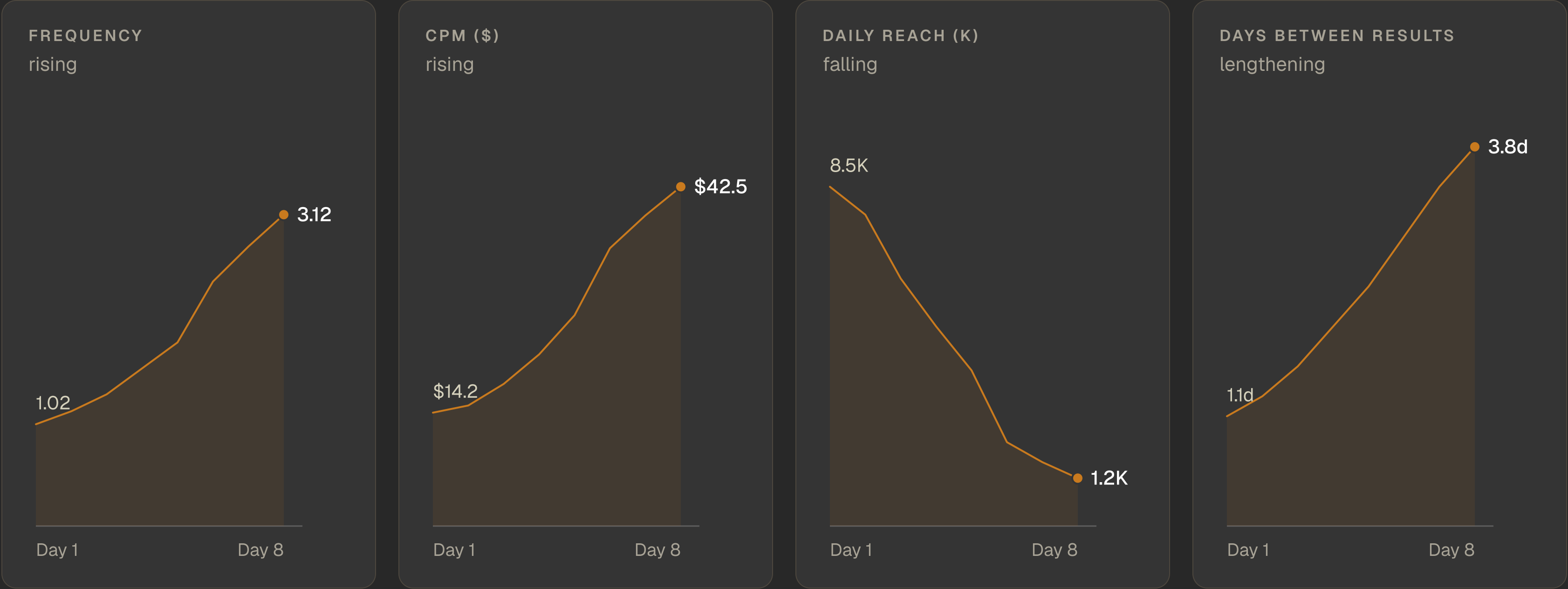
average stall at \$10/day

6 of 17

ended net-negative — 11 stayed profitable

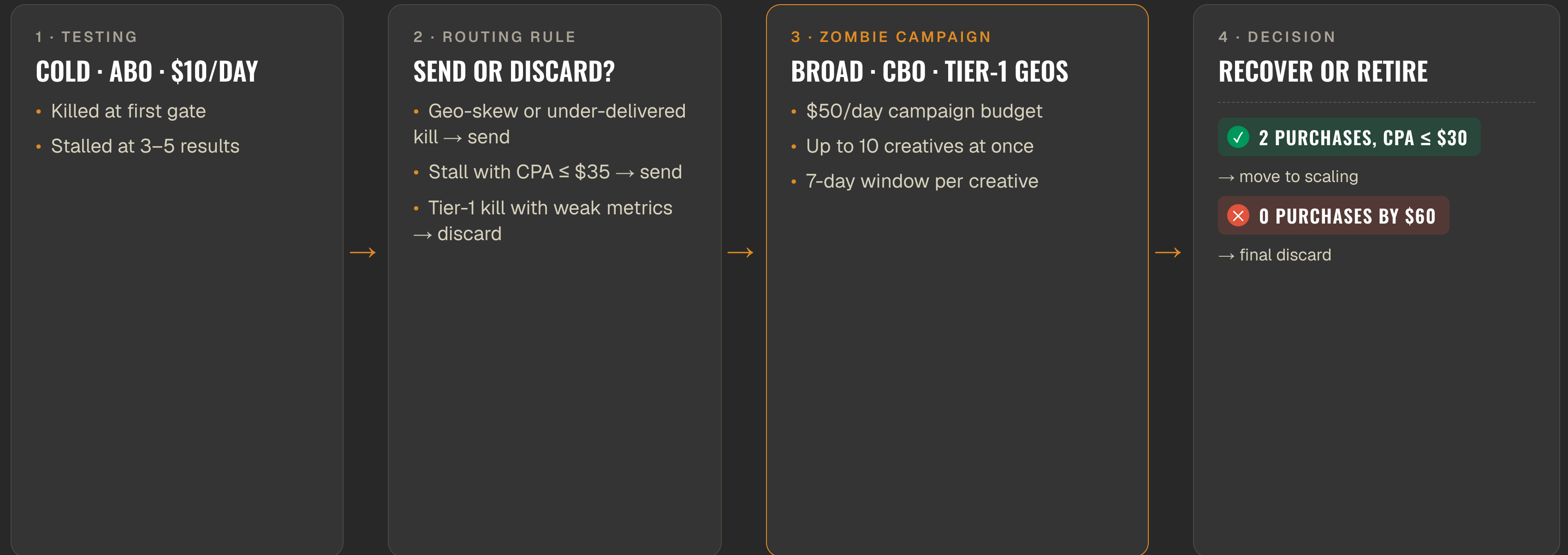
→ The stall is not always a loss — but on average it burned 50% of the profit these creatives had already earned.

THE COLD TEST AUDIENCE RUNS DRY DURING THE STALL



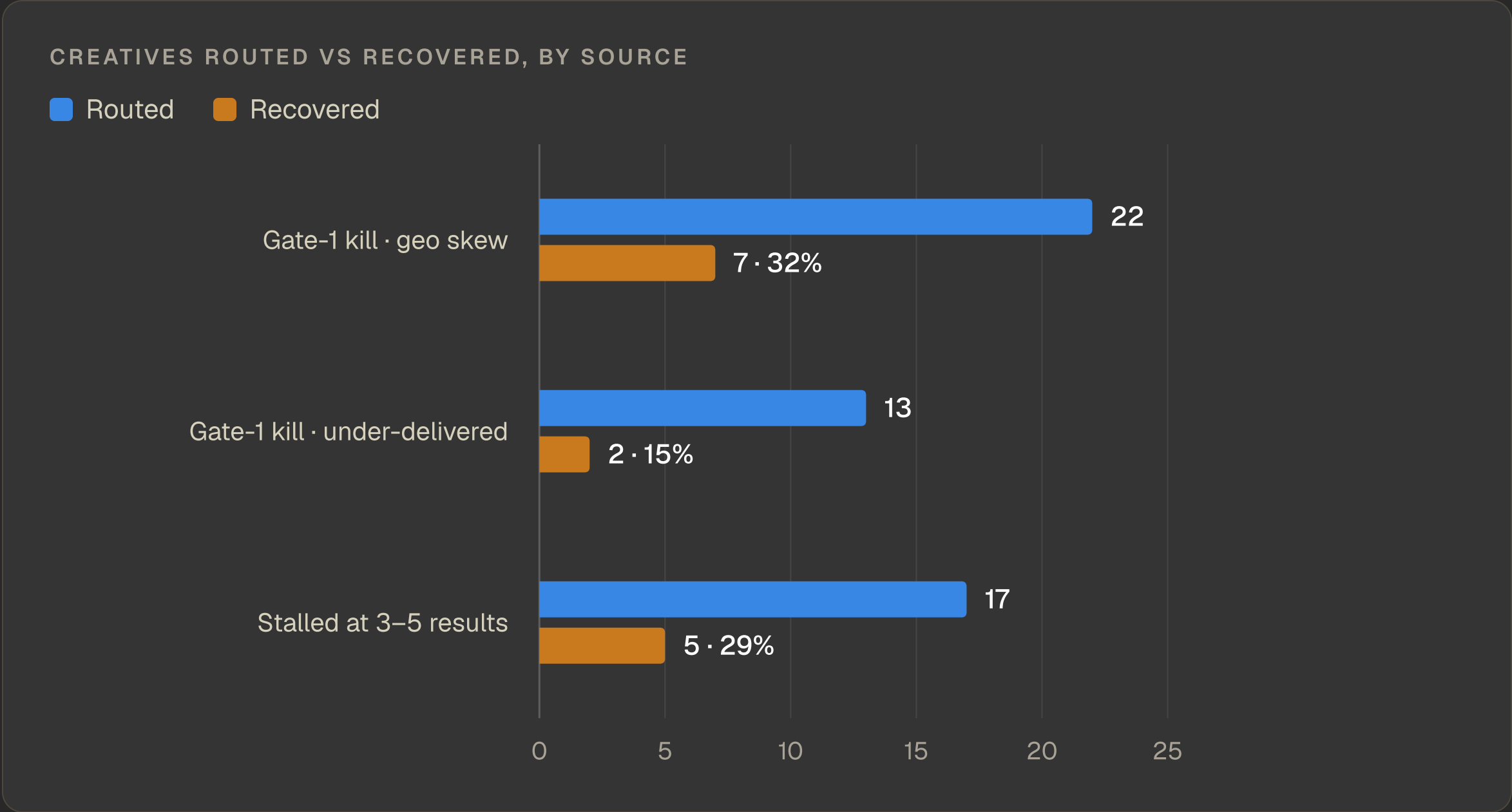
→ Average of stalled creatives, day 1–8 of the stall: a narrow cold audience at \$10/day is used up — then the creative is judged on it.

ROUTE LOST CREATIVES INTO THE ZOMBIE CAMPAIGN



→ Lost creatives get a second test on the broad, Tier-1 audience they would actually scale into — with a hard stop so it can't become a budget leak.

THE ZOMBIE CAMPAIGN RECOVERED 14 CREATIVES AND \$14,250



\$14,250

profit from recovered creatives

\$4,500

Zombie Campaign spend

+31.4%

lift in overall testing ROI

→ Geo-skew kills recover best (1 in 3) — exactly the false kills Point 1 describes.

FEWER LOST CREATIVES, LOWER FALSE-KILL RATE

■ Without Zombie ■ With Zombie FALSE-KILL RATE = PROJECTION



→ Every \$1 in the Zombie Campaign returned about \$3.17 in recovered profit in this test data.

04

POINT FOUR

JUDGE CONCEPTS, NOT INDIVIDUAL CREATIVES

Today the learning dies with the creative. Learn at the level of the concept family so every test gives production direction.

34 We Produce the Most of What Scales the Least

36 Some Concepts Hold Their ROAS — Others Fade

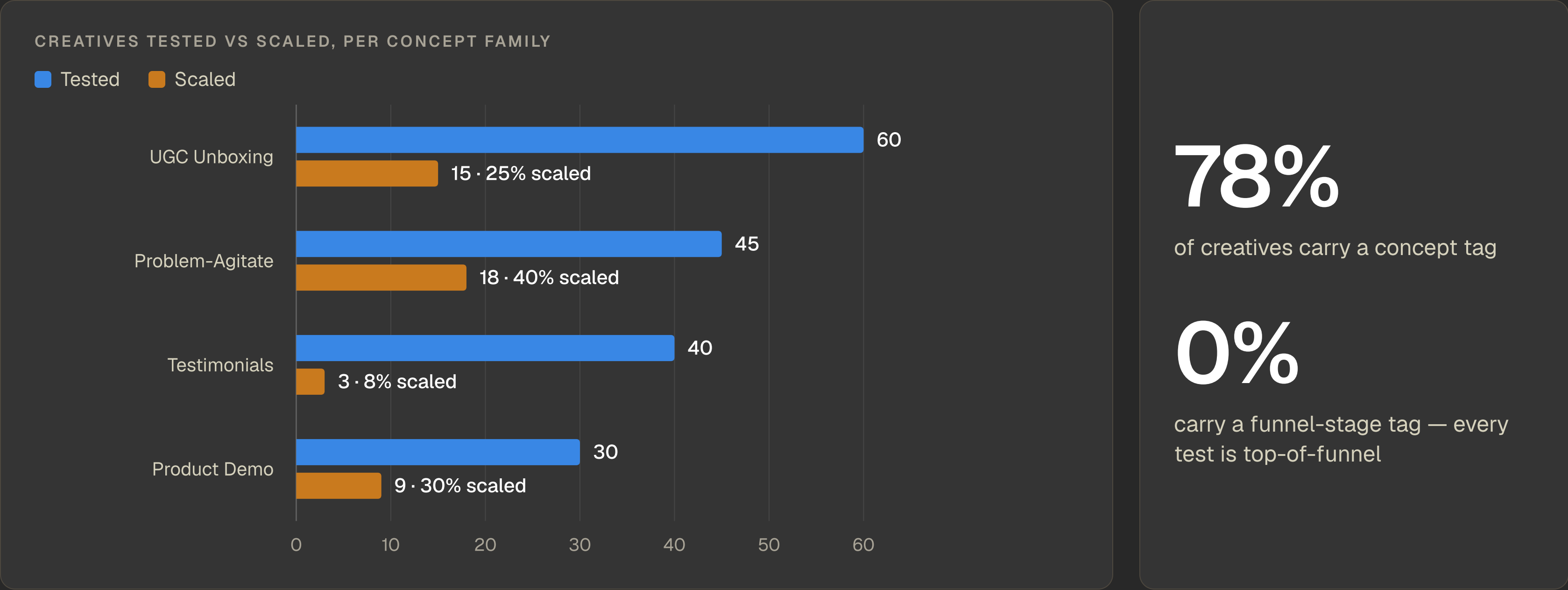
38 Same Production Budget, More Winners

35 Testimonials Fail Cold and Win Warm

37 Allocate Production by Concept Success Rate



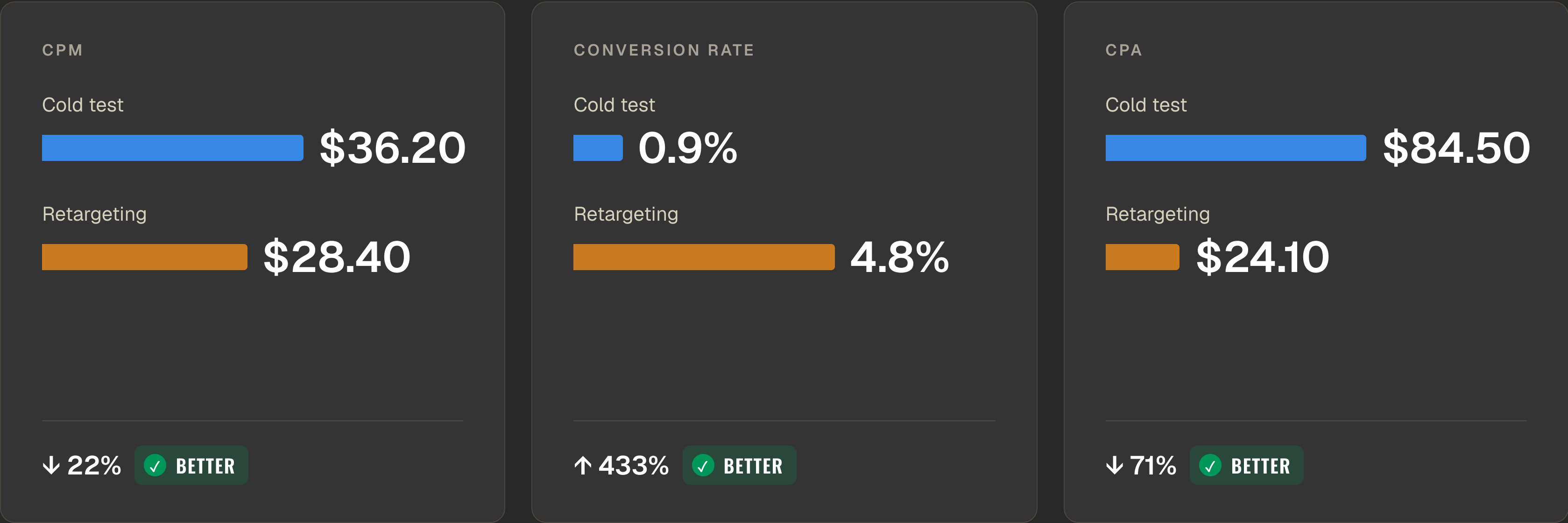
WE PRODUCE THE MOST OF WHAT SCALES THE LEAST



→ UGC Unboxing gets the most production but scales 1 in 4; Problem-Agitate scales 2 in 5.

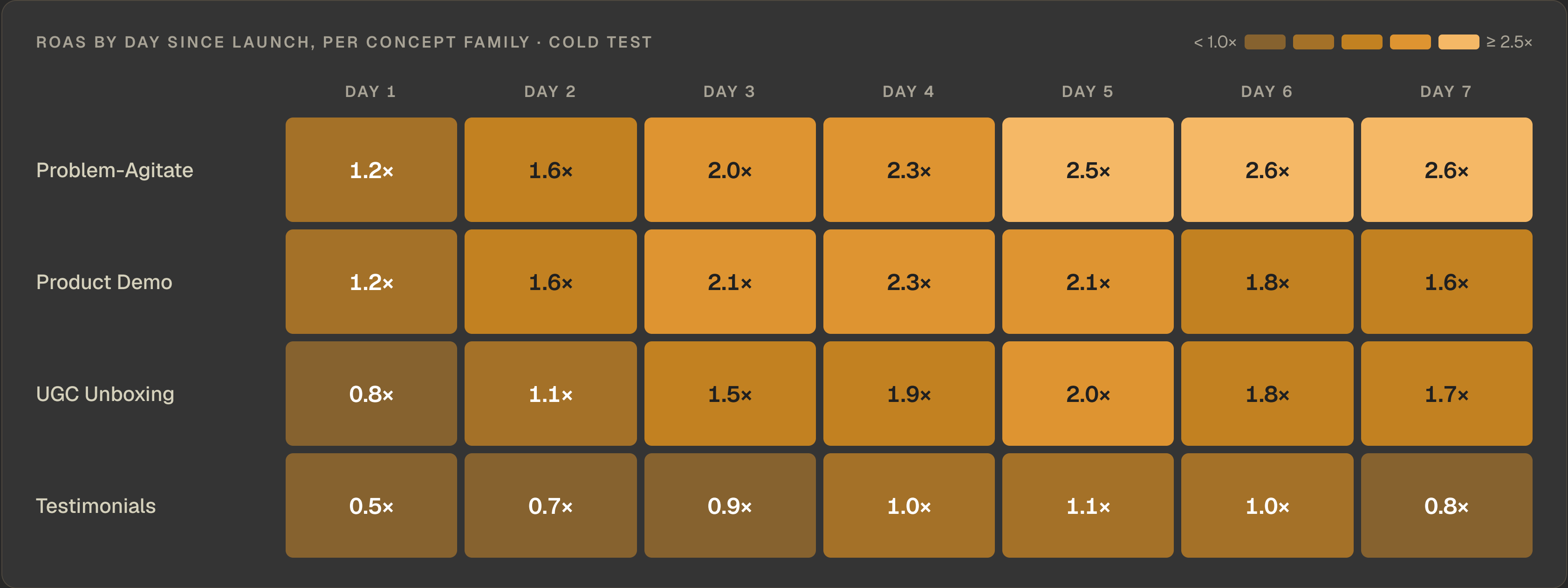
TESTIMONIALS FAIL COLD AND WIN WARM

Cold test campaign Retargeting (warm)



→ Same 40 testimonial creatives: 12.5% passed the cold first gate, yet in retargeting CPA fell to \$24.10 — a funnel mismatch, not a weak concept.

SOME CONCEPTS HOLD THEIR ROAS — OTHERS FADE



→ Problem-Agitate climbs and holds 2.6x by day 7; testimonials never pass 1.1x on cold traffic — durability belongs in the concept score.

ALLOCATE PRODUCTION BY CONCEPT SUCCESS RATE

CONCEPT FAMILY	PRODUCED	PASSED GATE 1	REACHED EXIT	SCALED	SUCCESS RATE	DIRECTION
Problem-Agitate	45	21	20	18	40.0%	↑ PRODUCE MORE
Product Demo	30	13	11	9	30.0%	= KEEP VOLUME
UGC Unboxing	60	24	19	15	25.0%	↓ REDUCE VOLUME
Testimonials	40	5	4	3	7.5%	↔ TEST IN RETARGETING

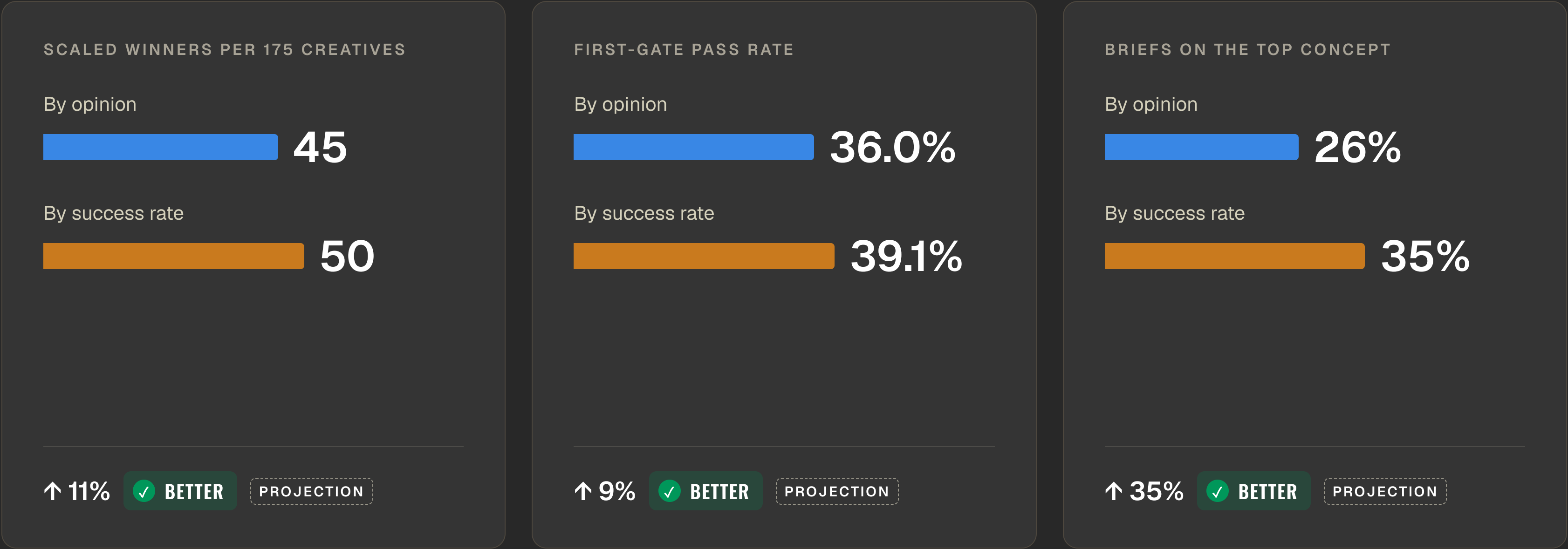
HOW BUYERS USE IT Per-creative gates (Points 1–3) still decide each asset; concept success rates decide what we brief and produce next.

→ Sorted by scaling success: shift volume toward Problem-Agitate and move Testimonials to a warm-audience test.

SAME PRODUCTION BUDGET, MORE WINNERS

Allocated by opinion Allocated by concept success

ALLOCATED BY SUCCESS = PROJECTION



→ Projected: moving 16 testimonial briefs to Problem-Agitate adds about 5 scaled winners per 175 creatives.

WHERE EACH CAMPAIGN STANDS — LAST 30 DAYS

CAMPAIGN	SPEND	CPM	CTR	CPA	ROAS	7D CHANGE	STATUS
Broad Scale · CBO	\$18,420	\$31.80	1.90%	\$42.20	2.70×	↑ 12%	↑ SCALE
Creative Test · ABO cold	\$12,000	\$27.40	2.60%	\$58.10	1.60×	↓ 8%	! WATCH
Retargeting · Warm	\$5,280	\$44.70	3.80%	\$29.60	4.10×	↑ 19%	↑ STRONG
Zombie Recovery · CBO	\$4,500	\$24.10	2.20%	\$47.50	2.20×	↑ 6%	↔ RECOVER
Testimonials · Retargeting	\$1,450	\$39.20	3.10%	\$24.10	3.60×	↑ 9%	↑ EXPAND

→ Click a column heading to sort. Retargeting and the Zombie campaign both beat the cold creative test on ROAS — the test is the weakest place we judge creatives.

OPEN ITEMS TO CONFIRM

POINT 1

- ☐ Country tier definition
- ☐ Geo-skew threshold (e.g. >60% spend)
- ☐ Minimum impressions / LPV at \$70
- ☐ Re-test policy for geo kills

POINT 2

- ☐ Definition of a "result"
- ☐ Definition of scaling success
- ☐ Sample size of exited creatives
- ☐ Attribution window

POINT 3

- ☐ Zombie data completeness
- ☐ Routing criteria
- ☐ Per-creative profit availability
- ☐ Budget ownership

POINT 4

- ☐ Concept tagging coverage
- ☐ Concept granularity
- ☐ Minimum sample per concept
- ☐ Funnel-stage testing in scope?

→ Each item turns a judgment call into a fixed number — without them, two buyers will apply the same rule differently.

■ DECISIONS WE NEED TODAY

APPROVE, VALIDATE, **START**

Point 1 is ready to roll out next cycle. Points 2–4 move forward once the open items are confirmed on real data.

01 · APPROVE

TWO-STAGE FIRST GATE

Roll out \$70 / \$100 rules next cycle.

02 · VALIDATE

COMBINED EXIT SIGNAL

Run on real data before replacing 10 results.

03 · CONFIRM

ZOMBIE ROUTING & BUDGET

Owner, budget line and routing criteria.

04 · START

CONCEPT & FUNNEL TAGGING

Tag every new creative from this week.